PUBLIC HEARING · CASE ZA-2027-118

Riverside Mixed-Use Rezoning

The department's testimony on the application to rezone the 14-acre former rail yard from industrial to mixed-use.

The department's position: approve the rezoning, with three binding conditions.

The application meets the comprehensive plan's housing and transit goals. We recommend approval conditioned on affordability set-asides, riverfront access, and traffic mitigation — the three matters where the as-filed plan falls short of policy.

The site has sat vacant for eleven years since the rail yard closed.

The 14-acre parcel was rezoned industrial in 1974 and has produced no jobs or housing since the yard ceased operations in 2016. The comprehensive plan designates this corridor for transit-oriented mixed-use.

What the applicant proposes to build.

A phased development of 620 housing units, 84,000 square feet of ground-floor retail, and a riverfront public esplanade, anchored to the light-rail station opening two blocks north in 2029.

- Density is within the corridor's adopted maximum.
- Phase one breaks ground 18 months after approval.

What the comprehensive plan requires of any approval here.

01

Affordability set-aside

At least 15% of units must be affordable at 60% of area median income.

02

Public riverfront access

Continuous public access along the full river frontage, dedicated in perpetuity.

03

Traffic mitigation

Intersection improvements sized to the development's projected peak trips.

04

Transit integration

A direct pedestrian connection to the future light-rail platform.

IMPACT · AS-CONDITIONED

What the project delivers to the corridor.

Projected at full build-out across the three development phases.

620	93	1,100	$4.8M
HOUSING UNITS	AFFORDABLE UNITS	JOBS AT BUILD-OUT	ANNUAL TAX BASE ADDED

Where the as-filed plan falls short of policy.

The application meets the density and transit goals but proposes only 9% affordable units, treats riverfront access as a private amenity, and omits the intersection study the traffic threshold requires. Each gap is the basis for a condition.

The summary of public comment received during the review period.

01	**Comments in support**	Cited housing need, jobs, and reuse of vacant land.	214
02	**Comments opposed**	Cited construction traffic and shadow on the adjacent neighbourhood.	88
03	**Comments conditional**	Supported the project if affordability and river access were guaranteed.	132
04	**Neighbourhood council**	Voted 6–1 to support, contingent on the three conditions.	

The opposition's traffic concern is real, and the condition answers it.

Construction-phase traffic on the residential approach is the most-cited objection. The proposed condition requires a phased haul-route plan and off-peak delivery windows, with a bonded penalty for violations — the standard mechanism applied to comparable corridor projects.

COMPARISON · STATUS QUO

What the corridor loses if the rezoning is denied.

Eleven-year vacancy continued, against the conditioned proposal.

0	$0	14	11 yrs
UNITS BUILT SINCE 2016	TAX REVENUE FROM THE SITE	ACRES HELD VACANT	AND COUNTING

> *We have waited eleven years for something to happen on that land. Build the homes, keep the river public, and fix the intersection. That is a fair trade.*

— Chair, Riverside Neighbourhood Council

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Approve the rezoning, with the three conditions that make it serve the plan.